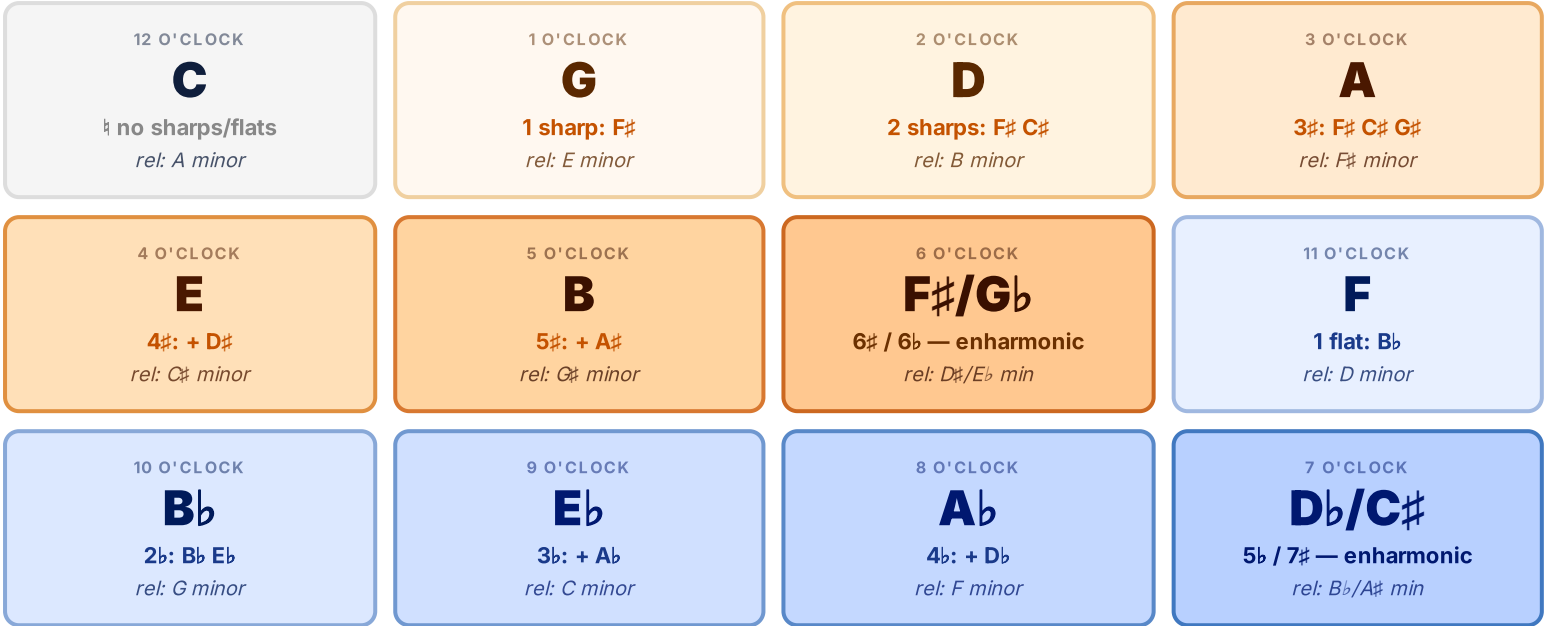


THE CIRCLE OF FIFTHS

All 12 major keys organized by harmonic distance — adjacent keys share 6 notes, opposite keys share almost none.

12 KEYS — CLOCKWISE = +1 SHARP (UP A PERFECT 5TH)



CLOCKWISE ►

+1 Sharp • Up a Perfect 5th

C → G → D → A → E → B → F#

Each step adds one sharp: F# C# G# D# A# E# B#

COUNTER-CLOCKWISE ◀

+1 Flat • Up a Perfect 4th

C → F → Bb → Eb → Ab → Db → Gb

Each step adds one flat: Bb Eb Ab Db Gb Cb Fb

ORDER OF SHARPS (FCGDAEB)

F# C# G# D# A# E# B#

ORDER OF FLATS (BEADGCF)

Bb Eb Ab Db Gb Cb Fb

HARMONIC DISTANCE

Adjacent keys (C ↔ G)

Share 6 of 7 notes. Closely related — key changes feel smooth and natural. One accidental difference.

Tritone-apart keys (C ↔ F#)

Share only 0–1 notes. Maximum harmonic distance. Distant key changes are dramatic and disorienting.